

chapter one

Communication in the Workplace



Upon completing this chapter, you will understand the role and nature of communication in business. To achieve this goal, you should be able to

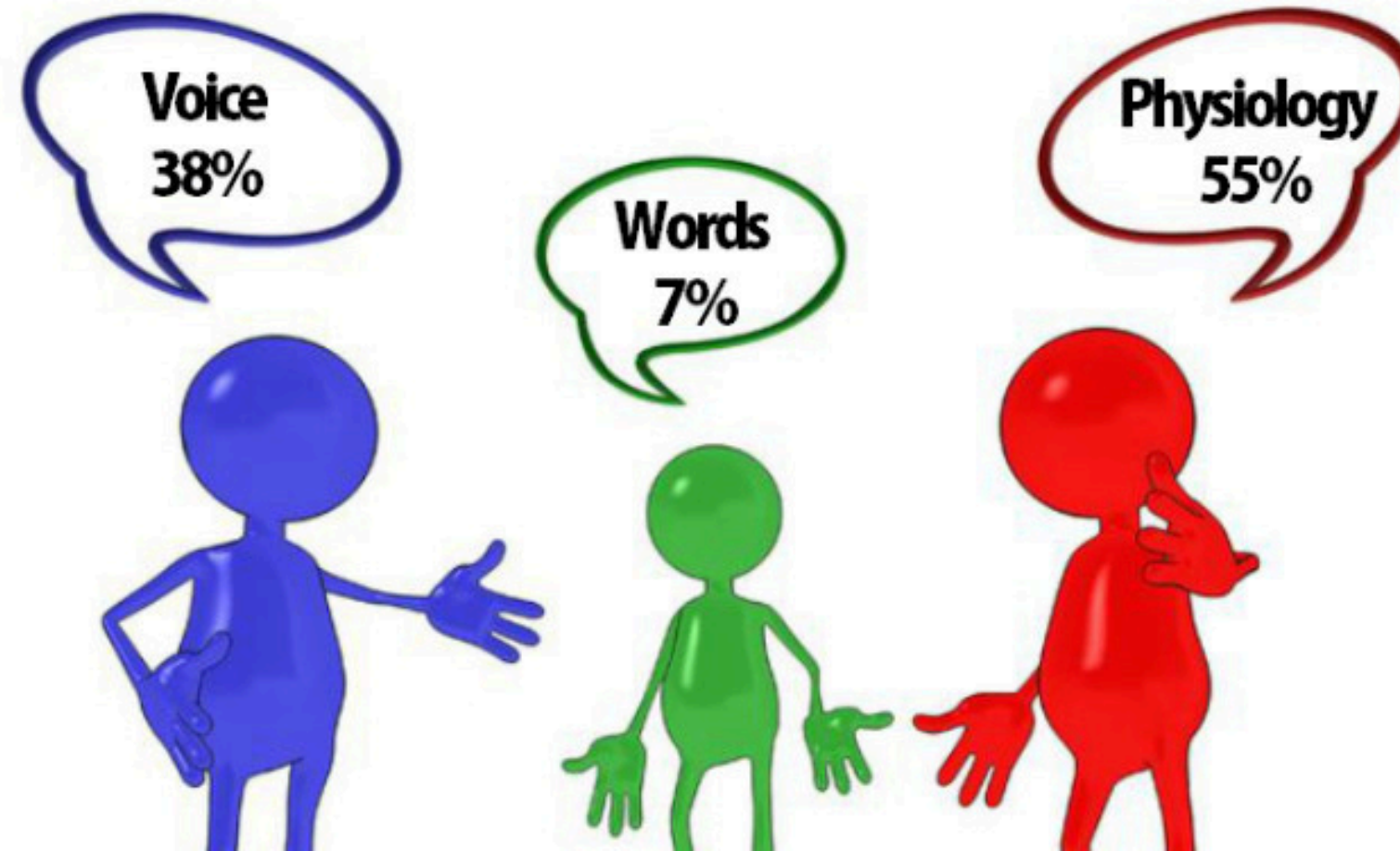
- 1** Explain the importance of communication to you and to business.
- 2** Describe the main challenges facing business communicators today.
- 3** Describe the three main categories of business communication.
- 4** Describe the formal and informal communication networks of the business organization.
- 5** Describe factors that affect the types and amount of communicating that a business does.
- 6** Explain why business communication is a form of problem solving.
- 7** Describe the various contexts for each act of business communication.
- 8** Describe the business communication process.

Learning Objectives

Communication

The process of sending and receiving messages. However, communication is effective only when the message is understood and when it stimulates action or encourages the receiver to think in new ways.

What is Communication?



Facts :

- 55% perceived non verbally.
- 7% depends on what is said.
- 38% depends on how it is said.

The Importance of Communication Skills to You

- Business needs good communicators
- Unfortunately, business's need for employees with good communication skills is all too often not fulfilled.
- Effective communicators are, therefore, in high demand.
- There is a high correlation between communication skills and income.
- Team revealed that technology magnifies the exposure of one's communications skills, forcing workers to communicate more effectively and articulately because these skills will be showcased more.
- Whatever position you have in business, your performance will be judged largely by your ability to communicate.
- Improving your communication skills improves your chances for success in business.

The Importance of Communication Skills to You

Communication is the most used skill in almost every job. How you communicate your accomplishments to others is a reflection of the quality of your work. Sure, you must know how to do your tasks to accomplish great results, but that is only a portion of professional success. Good communication skills are required to report your results to others, persuade colleagues to take action, and (most importantly at review time) sell your successes to management.

—Don Zatyko, Lead Project Manager
Kaiser Permanente

Communication is essential to building trust and teamwork among employees. To become a successful leader, you must have a great team. Just look at Michelangelo. He didn't paint the Sistine Chapel by himself, but with the help of his team. It is considered one of the best works in history. It's all about the team.

—Mark Federighi, National Account Director
Skyy Spirits

Why Business Depends Upon Communication

Every business, even a one-person business, is actually an economic and social system. To produce and sell goods and services, any business must coordinate the activities of many groups of people: employees, suppliers, customers, legal advisors, community representatives, government agencies that might be involved, and others. These connections are achieved through communication.

- Salespeople
- Executives
- Production Supervisors
- MKT professionals
- Researchers
- PR professionals

Current Challenges of Business Communications

1. The Ongoing Development of New Information Technologies.
2. The Increasingly Global Nature of Business.
3. Growing Diversity in the Workplace and in Types of Workplaces

Current Challenges of Business Communications

1. The Ongoing Development of New Information Technologies

- Information technologies from microchips, nanotechnologies, and the Internet to software, personal computers, and hand-held communication devices are fueling this competition.
- And as more and more means of acquiring, storing, retrieving, transmitting, and using information develop, what people do on the job becomes more and more information related. making smart use of communication technologies, which requires several kinds of literacy (verbal literacy, information literacy, technological literacy, visual literacy, etc.)

Current Challenges of Business Communications

2. The Increasingly Global Nature of Business

- E-commerce, communication technologies, and the expansion of business-based economies throughout the world have forged new connections among countries.
- The outsourcing of core business functions, such as manufacturing and customer service, to other countries is on the rise, and customers can come from all over the world.
- Businesspeople from other countries may have distinctly different attitudes about punctuality and efficiency . the core features of their culture, such as their preference for individualism or collectivism, their religious beliefs , their political environment , their ideas about social hierarchy , and their attitudes toward work itself can make their view of how to do business quite different from yours.
- On the other hand, global business is possible because businesspeople, from whatever country, generally do share certain goals and values. Your job as a cross-cultural communicator will be to learn about and honor others' cultural orientations in such a way that you and your communication partners can work together for mutual benefit.

Current Challenges of Business Communications

3. Growing Diversity in the Workplace and in Types of Workplaces

- An awareness of others' preferences and values is crucial not just for cross-cultural communication but also for communication within one's own country and one's own organization.
- One more widespread trend underway in business will likely affect the goals of the organization you work for. It is an increased focus on ethics and social responsibility .
- The Internet has brought a new transparency to companies' business practices, with negative information traveling quickly and widely
- Businesses now operate in an age of social accountability, and their response has been the development of corporate social responsibility (CSR) departments and initiatives.

Main Categories of Business Communication

There are three categories of communication in business.

1. **Internal-operational communication**

Internal-operational communication takes many forms. It includes the ongoing discussions that senior management undertakes to determine the goals and processes of the business. It includes the orders and instructions that supervisors give employees, as well as oral exchanges among employees about work matters.

2. **External-Operational Communication**

The work-related communicating that a business does with people and groups outside the business is external-operational communication. This is the business's communication with its publics—suppliers, service companies, customers, government agencies, the general public, and others.

Main Categories of Business Communication

3. Personal Communication

Not all the communication that occurs in business is operational. Personal communication helps make and sustain the relationships upon which business depends. Personal communication affects employee attitudes. The employees' attitudes toward the business, each other, and their assignments directly affect their productivity.

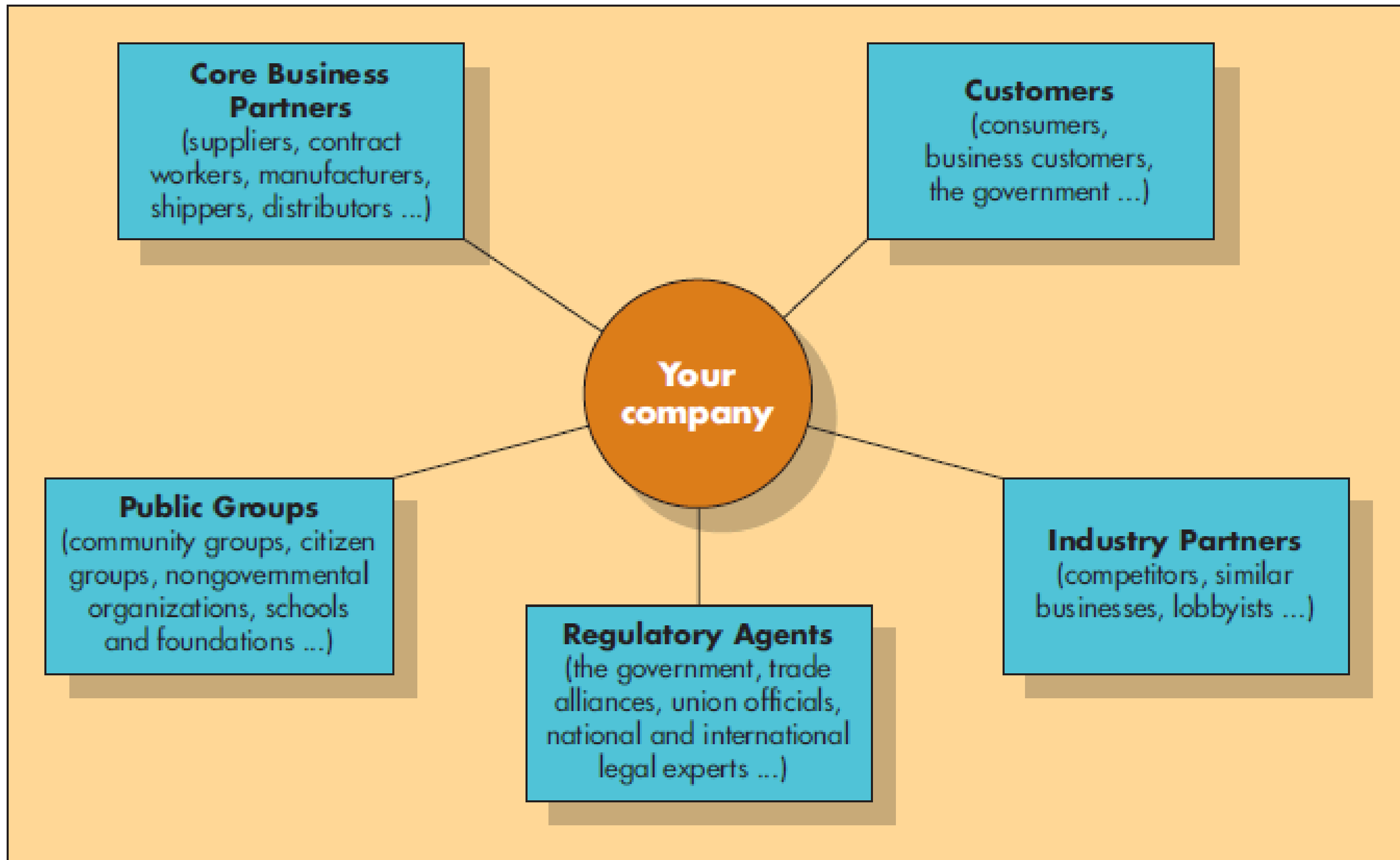


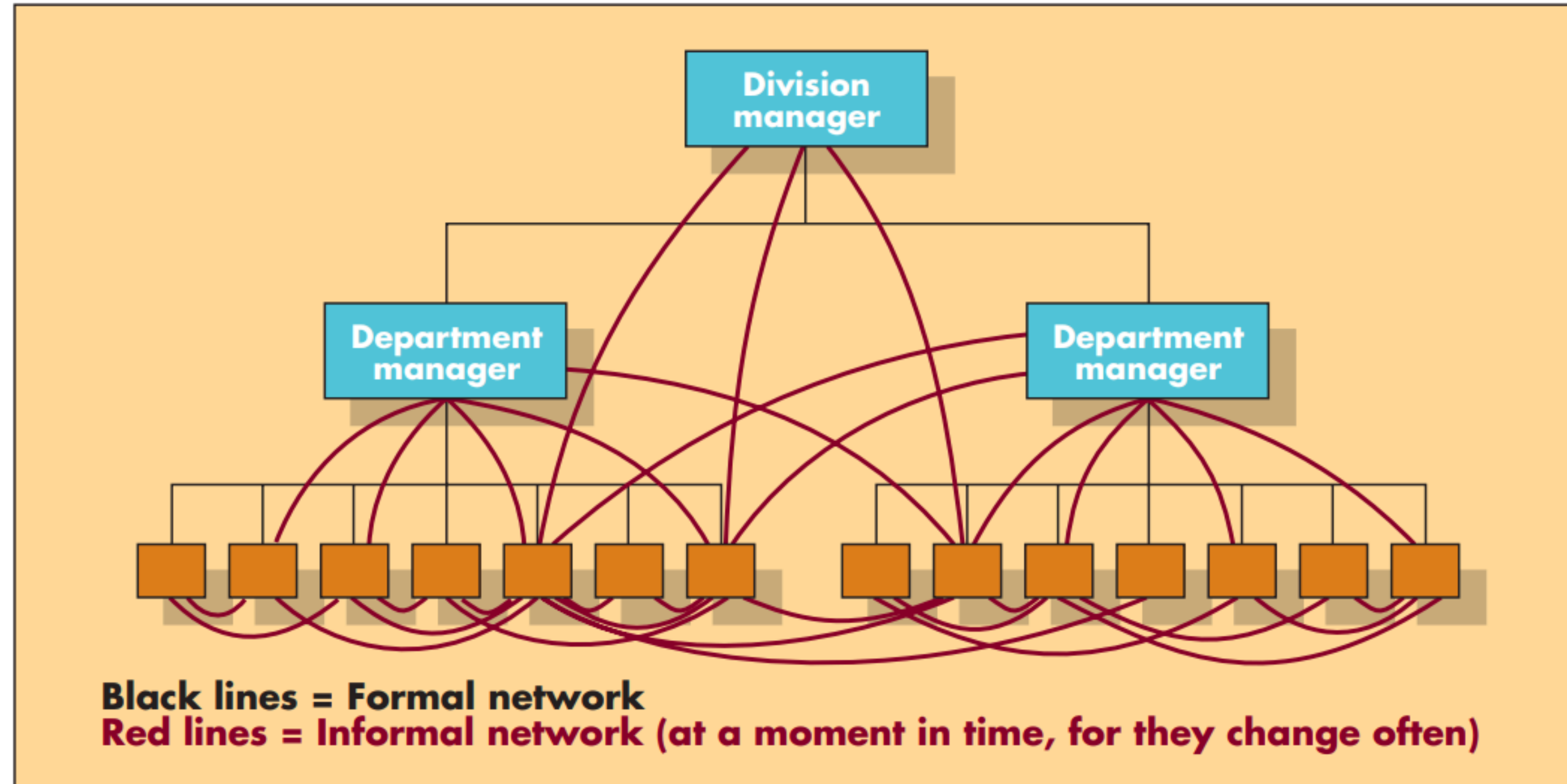
Figure 1–1

Likely External Audiences for Today's Businesses

Communication Networks of the Organization

Figure 1-2

**Formal and Informal
Communication Networks
in a Division of a Small
Business**



Communication Networks of the Organization

There are 2 communication networks in business.

1. The Formal Network

In simplified form, information flow in a modern business is much like the network of arteries and veins in the body. Just as the body has blood vessels, the business has major, well-established channels for information exchange. These are the formal channels—the main lines of operational communication. Through these channels flows the bulk of the communication that the business needs to operate. Specifically, the flow includes the upward, lateral, and downward movement of information in the form of reports, memos, email, and other media within the organization; the downward movement of orders, instructions, advisories, and announcements; and the broad dissemination of company information through the organization's newsletter, bulletin boards, email, intranet, or blogs.

Communication Networks of the Organization

2. The Informal Network

Operating alongside the formal network is the informal network. It comprises the thousands upon thousands of personal communications that may or may not support the formal communication network of a business. Such communications follow no set pattern; they form an ever-changing and infinitely complex structure linking the members of the organization.

The complexity of this informal network, especially in larger organizations, cannot be overemphasized. Typically, it is really not a single network but a complex relationship of smaller networks consisting of certain groups of people. The relationship is made even more complex by the fact that these people may belong to more than one group and that group memberships and the links between and among groups are continually changing.

Grapevine communication is the same as informal communication. The term "grapevine" specifically refers to the informal communication network within an organization, where information spreads through unofficial channels and social interactions.

Medium

- Letters
- Memo
- Report
- Notice board
- Faxes
- Telephone
- E-mail
- Face to face
- Body language
- Video/video conferencing
- Internet

Factors Affecting Volume of Communication in Business/ Variation In Communication Activity By Business

- Nature of the business (courier service, insurance company, housecleaning service)
- Business size and complexity (small personal business, automobile manufacturing company)
- Operating plan (business location)
- People (unique communication needs)

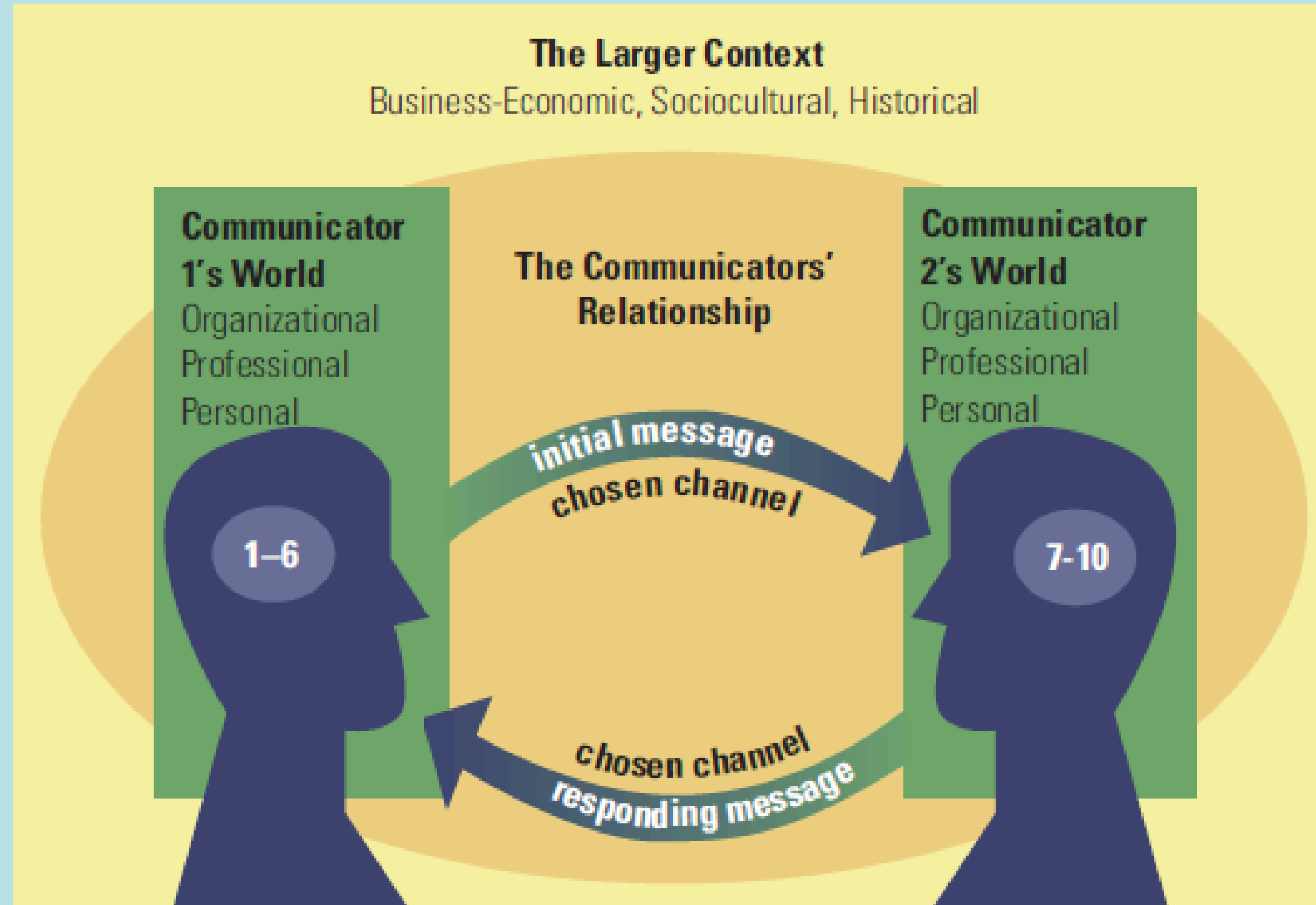
Figure 1-3

The Communication Process

The Business Communication Process

Communicator 1 ...

1. senses a communication need
2. defines the problem
3. searches for possible solutions
4. selects a course of action (message type, contents, style, format, channel)
5. composes the message
6. delivers the message



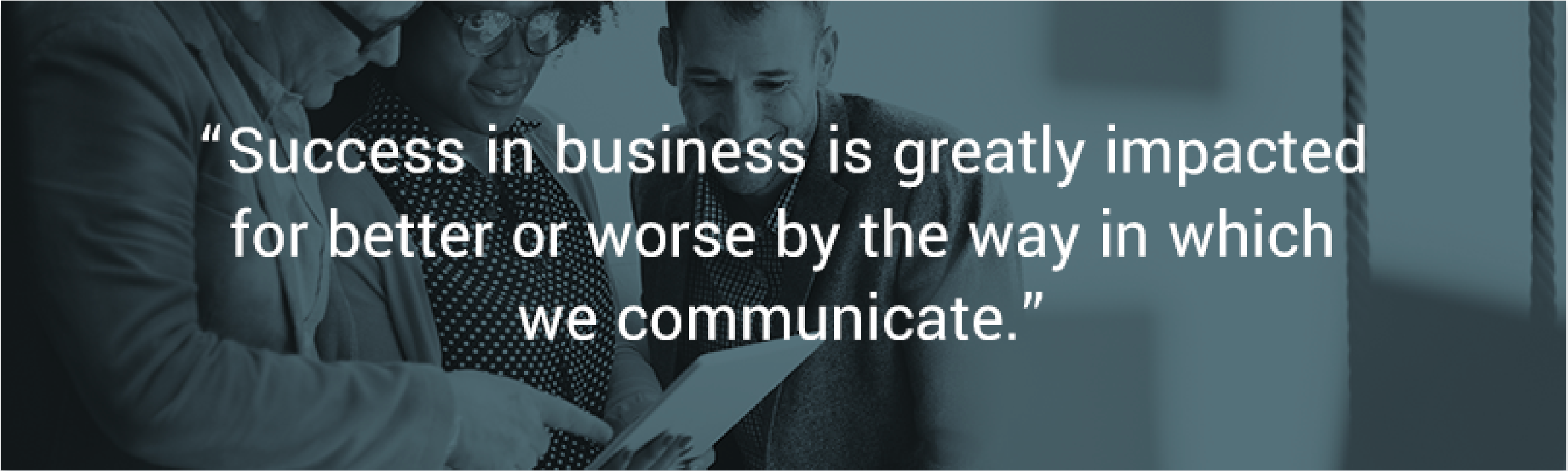
Communicator 2 ...

7. receives the message
8. interprets the message
9. decides on a response
10. may send a responding message

A Model of Business Communication Process



1. Sensing a need for communication
2. Defining the situation
3. Considering possible Communication strategies
4. Selecting a course of action
5. Composing the message
6. Sending the message
7. Receiving the message
8. Interpreting the message
9. Deciding on a response
10. Replying to the message



“Success in business is greatly impacted for better or worse by the way in which we communicate.”

